

SARAYU LANKA

EDUCATION

- Howard High School**, Ellicott City, Maryland
Expected in 06/2028
- Principal's Honor Roll for the year
 - 4.0 GPA
 - Professional Development: GT Independent Research
 - Robotics Team Member - Selected to be a part of the competition team, placed top ten in the DMV area as part of FIRST Tech Challenge
 - Science Olympiad - Qualified for States as a team after performance at regional-level competition
 - Mock Trial - Howard County High Schools Mock Trial Circuit, fourth place
 - Health Occupations Students of America(HOSA) Member
- Bonnie Branch Middle School**, Ellicott City, Maryland
06/2024
- Received the Presidential Award for Academic Excellence
 - Principal's Honor Roll all three years
 - 4.0 GPA

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

High school student with a strong background in computer science and artificial intelligence, holding certifications in Python and AWS. Passionate about applying technology to real-world challenges while exploring interests in medicine, biology, and mental health research. Experienced in coding, robotics, and STEM leadership, with a proven record of teaching, volunteering, and developing innovative AI-driven projects that bridge healthcare and technology.

SKILLS

- Strong technical background with coding, experience with programming languages and tools
- Javascript
- Django
- Research proficiency, especially in STEM-based topics
- Can work in an independent or collaborative atmosphere
- Python
- HTML & CSS
- Amazon Web Services
- Problem-solver, ability to utilize resources to fix issues

EXPERIENCE

CODE SENSEI 06/2025 to Current

Code Ninjas, Hanover, Maryland

- Instruct students ages 5–14 in coding fundamentals, progressing from block based coding to JavaScript and Python.
- Mentor students in game development, debugging, and creative problem-solving.
- Adapt lessons to different learning styles while fostering an engaging, supportive environment.
- Organized and detail-oriented with a strong work ethic.

VOLUNTEER 06/2025 to Current

LightHouse Senior Living, Ellicott City, Maryland

- Assisted residents with daily activities, mobility, and basic care tasks under staff supervision
- Served meals and supported residents during dining to ensure comfort and safety
- Engaged with residents in conversations and activities to promote well-being
- Collaborated with staff to create a supportive, caring environment for residents

AI DIVISION OFFICER AND TUTOR 03/2024 to Current

Scientific Minds of America, United States

- Officer of Initiatives Division, specifically Artificial Intelligence(AI) Camp. Introducing Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence to kids in middle school(grade six through grade eight).
- Helps children answer the question of how AI is used all around us, and in combination with the internet.
- Tutor of two students helping them to academically excel. Mentors in core subjects primarily English Language Arts, and Math.

BLACK BELT MARTIAL ARTIST 01/2018 to Current

Victory Martial Arts, Elkridge, Maryland

- Part of the STORM team - Handpicked group of students with potential within the dojang, taught to be leaders and role models
- Participated in tournaments(first place in traditional forms at the Battle of Baltimore)
- Black Belt 1st Degree

PIANIST 02/2014 to Current

Ellicott City, Maryland

- Developed proficiency in advanced piano techniques such as trills, glissandos, arpeggios, pedaling skills and ornamentation.
- Performed improvisational pieces that showcased creativity while maintaining stylistic integrity.
- Performed before live audiences in concerts, recitals, educational presentations, and other social gatherings.
- In progress for the London College of Music (Certification Track)

RESEARCH INTERNSHIP 07/2025 to 08/2025

Sunshine For Cancer Kids, Ellicott City, Maryland

- developed research experience on pediatric cancer by writing professional papers and publishing them on the official website
- Promoted advocacy and gained knowledge in these topics
- Gained strong organizational and time management skills by completing multiple tasks

- simultaneously
- Demonstrated ability to take initiative and work independently on assigned projects
- Completed internship with high honors

PROJECTS 01/2020 to Current

Self-directed, Ellicott City Maryland

Journo: Mental health app for teenagers

- Using React Native and Expo Go for testing - Still in progress, aims to incorporate AI models with AWS Bedrock
- Gained experience in UI development, as well as API building/deployment with Python and Lambda in runtime environment
- Amazon Web Services

Automated Call Center:

- Assisted in building an automated call center
- Used AWS to automate business hour responses through Lambda, and employing Python
- Then, utilized AWS service Polly to convert text into lifelike speech, and Amazon Connect to add to flow

Integration of Databases(Relational and Non-relational) with APIs:

- Helped build search feature in an app
- Used Lambda and API gateway to do process, made use of features including mapping templates, deployment stages, and logs
- PostMan to test APIs

WEBSITE MANAGER 04/2025 to Current

HoCo Monumental, Ellicott City, Maryland

- HOCO Monumental is an organization that stands to destigmatize mental health, raise awareness for it through an online platform, and invite promotion with events and activities
- Manage and lead a team of 60+ blog writers, handle the organization website
- collaborate with the rest of the leadership team to further improve Monumental and its ability to advocate for mental health

CERTIFICATIONS

- PCEP – Certified Entry-Level Python Programmer certification
- PCAP – Certified Associate Python Programmer certification
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner certification
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner certification

LANGUAGES

English



Native or Bilingual

French



Limited Working

Telugu



Native or Bilingual

AWARDS

- The Presidential Award for Educational Excellence, Individual recognition from the President and the U.S. Secretary of Education to those students whose outstanding efforts have enabled them to meet challenging standards of excellence
- Outstanding Officer Award at SMOA, Recognition to those who demonstrated exceptional dedication to the SMOA initiatives and performed outstanding service as a SMOA officer